

Narrative Report

Cyber Innovation and IP Protection: What Every Student Should Know

April 25, 2026

8:00 AM – 10:00 AM



A two-hour online seminar entitled "Cyber Innovation and IP Protection: What Every Student Should Know" took place on April 25, 2026, running from 8:00 in the morning until 10:00 AM. The event sought to equip students with a solid grasp of intellectual property (IP), its relevance, and the vital role it plays in fostering innovation within the ever-evolving digital era.

Program Flow and Highlights

The event formally commenced with opening remarks delivered by the moderator, Christine Luzon German, who maintained an efficient and orderly flow throughout the program. This was followed by an invocation led by Ma'am



Glenda P. Binay, an IT faculty member from the Bongabong Campus, whose prayer set a reverent and uplifting atmosphere for the occasion.

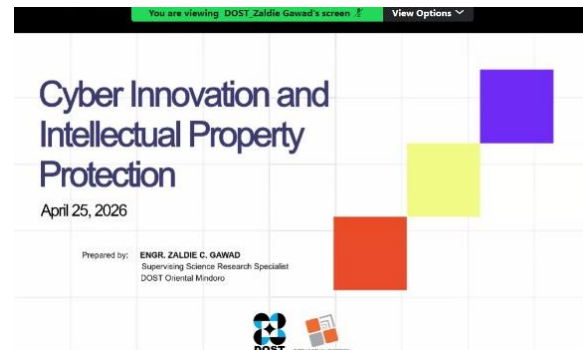


Dr. Epie Custodio, serving as Program Chair and IT faculty of the Calapan Campus, delivered the welcome address. He stressed the growing need for students to understand intellectual property in a world increasingly shaped by technology. Following this, Dr. John Edgar S. Anthony, Dean of the College of Computer Studies, shared an inspiring message urging students to cherish their own creativity and to appreciate why legally safeguarding their ideas matters as they move toward professional life.



The resource speaker, Engr. Zaldie C. Gawad, a Supervising Science Research Specialist from DOST Oriental Mindoro, was formally introduced by Ma'am Sarah Jane M. Festijo. His extensive background in cyber innovation and intellectual property provided an authoritative foundation for the main discussion that followed.

Main Presentation



The highlight of the webinar was the presentation delivered by Engr. Zaldie C. Gawad, Supervising Science Research Specialist of DOST Oriental Mindoro, who served as the guest lecturer. His talk centered on cyber innovation and the legal mechanisms available for protecting intellectual property. He introduced IP as products of human creativity that are granted legal protection, giving their creators exclusive rights over their use.

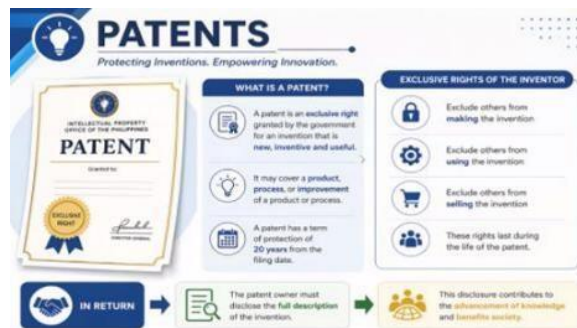
The speaker went on to explain that Intellectual Property Rights (IPR) fall under two broad categories: industrial property and copyright. Industrial property encompasses patents, trademarks, industrial designs, and geographic indications, whereas copyright extends to literary pieces, musical compositions, films, software, and various other creative expressions.

He elaborated further on the various forms of IP rights — which include patents, trademarks, copyright, industrial designs, and the safeguarding of confidential information — underscoring their collective importance in defending original works and sustaining a culture of creativity and innovation.



Deeper Discussion on IP Types

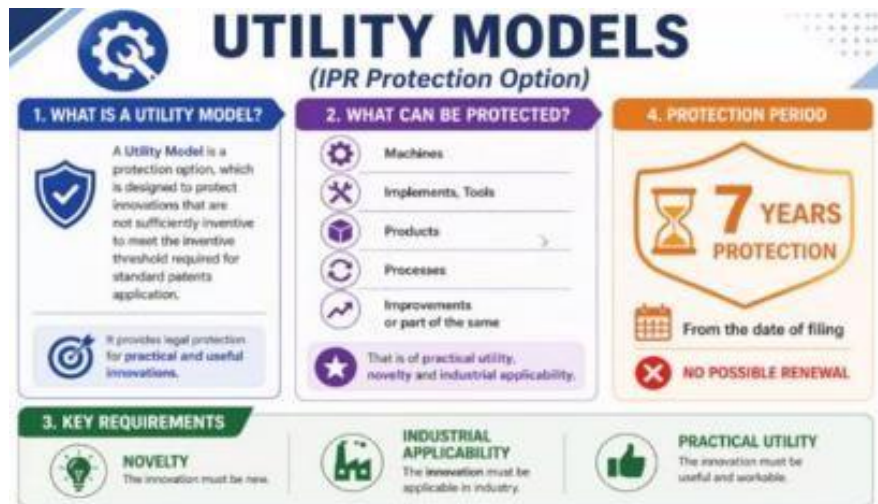
The discussion further delved into a more thorough explanation of important intellectual property concepts:



- **Patents** – These confer exclusive rights over newly created, useful, and inventive products or processes for a period of up to 20 years. The speaker outlined the specific conditions for patent eligibility — covering what qualifies and what does not — while also highlighting how publicly disclosing inventions can advance society as a whole.

- **Utility Models** – These offer a shorter-term form of protection, generally lasting seven years, designed for functional innovations that may fall short of full patent requirements yet still deliver meaningful practical benefits.

To illustrate these concepts practically, the Palatak Palay Seeder was cited as an example of a locally protected invention that has significantly boosted agricultural output and improved the livelihoods of Filipino farmers across the country.



INNOVATION FROM THE FIELDS OF MINDORO
PALATAK PALAY SEEDER
 BONGABONG, ORIENTAL MINDORO

Modern Technology. Local Ingenuity. Stronger Harvests.

The Palatak Palay Seeder is a manually operated, row-type rice seeder engineered to deliver uniform seed placement and optimal seed-to-soil contact. It improves plant stand, reduces seed wastage, saves time and labor, and increases overall farm productivity.

PROVEN, TRUSTED, NATIONWIDE
 From October 2024 to April 14, 2025, the Palatak Palay Seeder has achieved remarkable success nationwide!

1,008 UNITS SOLD	72 PROVINCES ADOPTED
406 DEMONSTRATIONS	55 MINDANAO ISLANDS

BUILT FOR FILIPINO FARMERS
 "Kalyapang ng ating teknolohiya, para sa nangangailang ng ating Pilipino."

KEY FEATURES

- Uniform seed spacing
- Adjustable seed rate
- Simple & Durable
- Adaptable to various terrain
- Cost-Effective
- Time & Labor Efficient
- Simple to Operate

BENEFITS TO FARMERS & COMMUNITY

- Increases productivity
- Reduces seed wastage
- Promotes sustainable farming
- Supports local economy and employment

PALATAK PALAY SEEDER - A LOCAL INNOVATION, A NATIONAL IMPACT

• **Copyright** – This form of protection takes effect automatically for original creations, including software, from the instant of their creation. The speaker pointed out that honoring copyright not only nurtures creativity but also fuels the expansion of the digital economy by allowing creators to reap the rewards of their efforts.

INDUSTRIAL DESIGN

An industrial design is the ornamental or aesthetic aspect of an article.

THE DESIGN MAY CONSIST OF:

- THREE-DIMENSIONAL FEATURES such as the shape or surface of an article
- TWO-DIMENSIONAL FEATURES such as patterns, lines or colors

APPLIED TO MANY PRODUCTS

- Medical Instruments
- Watches
- Jewelry
- Furniture & Home Decor
- Electrical Appliances
- Vehicle
- Shoe Design
- Leather Goods
- Leisure Items
- And many more!

DESIGN PROTECTION

When an industrial design is protected, the owner - the person or entity that has registered the design - is assured an exclusive right against unauthorized copying or imitation of the design by third parties.

AN EFFECTIVE SYSTEM OF PROTECTION ALSO:

- Benefit consumers and the public at large
- Promotes fair competition and honest trade practices
- Encourages creativity
- Promotes more aesthetically attractive products

PROTECT DESIGNS. PROMOTE CREATIVITY. ENCOURAGE INNOVATION.

• **Trademarks** – These grant brand owners exclusive authority over their marks, shielding them from unauthorized use of similar names, logos, or designs. The session also covered the trademark registration process and the lasting advantages it provides, such as a stronger brand identity and greater consumer confidence.

TRADEMARK PROTECTION

- 1. WHAT IS TRADEMARK PROTECTION?**
 - A trademark can be protected through registration, giving the owner exclusive rights over the mark.
- 2. RIGHTS OF THE TRADEMARK OWNER**
 - Exclusive right to use the mark.
 - Right to prevent others from using identical or similar marks.
 - Applies to identical or related goods and services.
- 3. BEFORE YOU APPLY**
 - CONDUCT A TRADEMARK SEARCH**
 - Search in the trademarks database.
 - Determine if there are identical or similar marks.
 - Helps avoid problems in the registration of your mark.
- 4. WHAT CAN BE REGISTERED UNDER TM?**
 - A mark must be distinctive and capable of distinguishing the goods or services of one entity from those of others.
 - Words (e.g., brand names, slogans)
 - Letters & Numbers
 - Logos & Symbols
 - Colors (in connection with goods)
 - 3D Shapes (e.g., product packaging)
 - Sounds (e.g., jingles, jingles, jingles)
- 5. YEARS OF PROTECTION, RENEWAL & DURATION**
 - INITIAL PROTECTION 10 YEARS**
 - RENEWABLE EVERY 10 YEARS**
 - The registration may be renewed for successive periods of 10 years upon payment of the prescribed fee.
 - DURATION**: As long as the mark is renewed every 10 years, the protection can continue indefinitely.

WHY IT MATTERS

- Builds brand identity and customer trust
- Protects your brand and reputation
- Provides legal protection and exclusive rights

• **Industrial Design** – This category of protection addresses the visual and aesthetic qualities of a product, acting as a safeguard against copying while encouraging healthy competition and ongoing creative development.

Project ISIP and Open Forum



The speaker also presented Project ISIP (Integrated System for Intellectual Property Registration), an online platform designed to make IP applications and management more accessible by linking users directly with qualified professionals and experts.

An open forum was then held, giving attendees the opportunity to raise questions and seek clarification on important topics, with both the moderator and the speaker actively addressing each query raised.



Closing Segment



A Certificate of Appreciation was presented to Engr. Zaldie C. Gawad in acknowledgment of his valuable contribution to the event. Closing remarks were then delivered by Franklin G. Lopez, who conveyed heartfelt thanks and reaffirmed the critical role that IP protection plays in driving innovation and supporting national progress.

On the whole, the webinar proved highly effective in broadening participants' understanding of intellectual property, motivating them to pursue their creative endeavors with confidence while exercising a sense of responsibility in protecting their own innovations.